Cranemoor Institute

Backup and recovery tier — member briefing for the binding AGM vote

Decision date: 18 September 2026 • Prepared by Jelena Trevelyan, Systems Manager • Supplier revision: 31 July 2026

The decision in one minute

The current baseline does not meet Granthill Authority recovery limits. I recommend the **Silver tier**: it is the least-cost available option that meets every applicable limit and can be completed before 30 November 2026. Gold is stronger, but its extra resilience is not required for this decision.

What members are funding

Silver protects 43.8 TB (6 supplier packs × 7.3 TB). It costs **£721.80 per month** (£8,661.60 recurring each year), plus **£1,400 one-time setup**. The first-year authority requested is therefore **£10,061.60**. Against the current baseline (£4,768.80 recurring annually), the recurring annual uplift is **£3,892.80**.

The terms in plain language

A recovery point is the latest saved copy we can restore. “Exposure” is the time between an interruption and that saved copy — not a promise that every service loses the same work. Model edits, document versions and render outputs behave differently.

Compare the available supplier tiers

Tier	Monthly recurring	Annual recurring	First year	Model edits at risk	Document version exposure	Authority result
Current baseline	£397.40	£4,768.80	£4,768.80	up to 240 min	up to 60 min	Does not meet
Copper tier	£545.00	£6,540.00	£7,390.00	up to 120 min	up to 30 min	Does not meet
Silver tier	£721.80	£8,661.60	£10,061.60	up to 60 min	up to 15 min	Meets limits
Gold tier	£984.30	£11,811.60	£14,011.60	up to 15 min	up to 5 min	Meets limits

Granthill Authority requirements effective 31 July 2026

• Model server (critical transactional): no more than 60 minutes of data-loss exposure.
• Versioned document store (controlled record): no more than 15 minutes between checkpoints/versions.
• Render farm (recreatable workload): protect source inputs; interrupted outputs are rerun, so a conventional drawing-work loss window is not applicable.

Why not Gold? Gold reduces model exposure to 15 minutes and document exposure to 5 minutes, but costs £11,811.60 recurring annually and £14,011.60 in its first year. That additional resilience is valid, not hidden; it is simply not needed to meet the stated limits.

One Tuesday afternoon, service by service

At **15:37 on Tuesday 15 September 2026**, the model server stops responding.

Service	Latest Silver recovery point before 15:37	What is recoverable / what may need work
Model server	15:00 completed hourly point	The 15:00 model is recoverable. Edits after 15:00 — up to 37 minutes — may need
Versioned document store	15:30 completed checkpoint	The 15:30 document version is recoverable; at most 7 minutes of changes may nee
Render farm	R-184 completed 15:20; R-185 interrupted 15:35	Completed source inputs remain available. R-185's output is disposable and must be

Recommendation and delivery

Silver is the lowest-cost compliant tier. The team can complete the eight source-defined activities by 30 November 2026 using working days (Monday–Friday): order, provision capacity, configure model and document protection, protect render inputs, test restoration, hand over operations and obtain final acceptance. The implementation roadmap assigns each activity to Thandiwe Kalinowski, Tamsin Yablonski or Ragnhild Jelinek with evidence and dependencies.

The motion for members

"That the members authorise Cranemoor Institute to adopt the Silver backup and recovery tier, approve first-year expenditure up to £10,061.60 (comprising £8,661.60 recurring annual cost and £1,400 setup), and approve the ongoing recurring annual budget of £8,661.60, with implementation completed by 30 November 2026."